Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Part A – Case Study (Phishing)

Phishing is one of the most common types of cybercrime where attackers try to steal sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs by pretending to be a trusted source. It usually happens through emails, SMS, or fake websites.

In a typical phishing attack, the victim receives a message that appears to be from a bank or a well-known company. The message creates urgency, such as "Your account will be blocked" or "Update your details immediately." It contains a link that redirects the user to a fake website that looks almost identical to the original one. When the user enters their login credentials or banking details, the information is directly captured by the attacker.

Students and general internet users are often targeted because they may not be fully aware of such scams. The consequences can be serious, including financial loss, identity theft, and misuse of personal data.

Phishing attacks can be prevented by being cautious online, avoiding suspicious links, and never sharing confidential information. Awareness is the key to staying safe from such cyber threats.

Part B – Prevention Checklist (Stay Safe Online)

- Never share OTP, PIN, or passwords with anyone
- Do not click on unknown or suspicious links
- Always check website URLs carefully before entering details
- Use strong and unique passwords for different accounts
- Enable two-factor authentication (2FA)
- Avoid using public Wi-Fi for online payments
- Do not download apps from unknown sources
- Always log out from shared or public devices

Reporting Channels:

- National Cyber Crime Portal: cybercrime.gov.in
- Helpline Number: 1930

Final Reflection

While researching about cybercrime, I was surprised to learn how easily people fall into phishing traps. Many fake messages and websites look so real that it becomes difficult to identify them. Even a small mistake like clicking on a suspicious link can lead to serious consequences such as loss of money or personal data theft.

After learning about this topic, I will be more careful while using the internet. I will avoid clicking on unknown links and will never share my personal or banking information online. I will also make sure to use strong passwords and enable extra security features like two-factor authentication. This awareness will help me stay safe and protect my digital identity in the future.